

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

What do you say when you get an unwanted call?



Learning Outcome

Exchange advice and suggestions in communicative situations.

Ask your partner:

- Have you ever had an unwanted phone call?
- How did you manage the conversation?
- What did you say to redirect or end the phone call?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about jobs and work.
- I can manage a phone conversation.
- I can change topics.





Let's Explore!

Vanessa gets an unwanted phone call at work.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Vanessa: Hello, Bistro 88, Vanessa speaking.

Salesperson: Hi. This is Jenny from Acme Restaurant Equipment Services. Can you please put me through to the manager?

Vanessa: I am the manager. How can I help you?

Salesperson: Oh, we have some new models of kitchen equipment that you'd be excited about. I was wondering if I could demonstrate them to you.

Vanessa: Oh, this isn't really a good day. I'm pretty tied up right now. Maybe another time. We're doing fine with our kitch ...

Salesperson: Actually, we're running a special discount campaign right now.

Vanessa: I'm sure it's all very exciting, but I really can't speak to you right now. We're terribly busy. I'm sorry. I must go.

Salesperson: No problem. I understand. When's the best time to call back?

Vanessa: Well ...

Salesperson: Why don't you check out our website? And then we could set up a video chat. Then you can look through our showroom live.

Vanessa: Actually, you're breaking up ...

Salesperson: It's www.acmekitchen.com

Vanessa: Super. Thanks so much. I've got to go.

Salesperson: Sure. I'll call up early next week. Thank you. Bye.

Vanessa: I hate salespeople who ring up like that.





Let's Practice!

This isn't really a good time.

Instructions: Read the conversation again. Mark all the correct statements.

1. The salesperson on the phone wants an appointment with Vanessa because ...

- ☐ she wants to demonstrate some new models of kitchen equipment.
- ☐ she wants to have a dinner party at Bistro 88.
- ☐ she wants to present the current discount campaign.
- ☐ she wants Vanessa to check out their showroom through video.
- ☐ she wants Vanessa to fix their website.

2. Vanessa doesn't wish to speak to the salesperson on the phone because ...

- ☐ her restaurant has no more space for new kitchen equipment.
- ☐ her restaurant doesn't require new kitchen equipment at the present.
- ☐ her restaurant has no money for new kitchen equipment.
- ☐ she's really busy today.
- ☐ she is not interested in buying new equipment.



Let's Practice!

When you're stuck on the phone, what do you say?

Instructions: Proofread the sentences. Correct the mistakes. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. I'm pretty tied up right now. Maybe oter time.
2. I'm sure it's all very exciting, but I realy can't speak to you right now.
3. We're teribli busy. I'm sorry. I must go.
4. Actually, you're breaking out.
5. Thanks so much. I've get to go.





Extension Activity

Write a dialogue about an unwanted phone call.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Imagine you get an unwanted call from a salesperson.
- Write a dialogue on what they're trying to present to you.
- Use expressions to change the topic.
- Write 8 - 10 lines.
- Practice your dialogue with your partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I write a dialogue for an unwanted phone call.

☐ ☐

I use proper phrases to change topics on the phone.

☐ ☐

I use appropriate intonation and rhythm for a phone conversation.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **to demonstrate** (verb): to physically show how something is done
e.g. I was wondering if I could demonstrate our new kitchen equipment to you.
- **tied up** (adjective): busy; occupied
e.g. I'm pretty tied up right now, so maybe another time.
- **terribly** (adverb): very to a stressful point
e.g. We're terribly busy. I'm sorry, but I must go.
- **to break up** (verb): when the other person's voice on the phone is unclear
e.g. Actually, you're breaking up. I can hardly hear you.
- **to call up** (verb): to try to reach someone on the phone
e.g. I'll call up again early next week.
- **to look through** (verb): to take a look; to have a preview
e.g. If we set up a video chat, you can look through our showroom live.





Learning Points

Phrasal Verbs about Phone Communication

A phrasal verb is a phrase formed with a verb + preposition. Some phrasal verbs are unique to communication on the phone.

Look at the following list of phrasal verbs. Try to use some of these the next time you're on the phone.

Phrasal Verb	Meaning
to call up/ring up	to call and try to reach someone on the phone
to get through	to succeed in speaking to someone on the telephone
to set up	to arrange another call or video chat
to hang on	to wait for a short time
to hold on	to wait for a short time
to put through	to connect a caller to someone in the office
to pick up	to answer a phone call
to speak up	to speak louder into the phone
to hang up	to end a conversation and disconnect
to cut off	to interrupt a phone conversation
to call back	to call someone again or in return
to break up	when the other person's voice is unclear and you can't hear them well

Examples:

- *Can you please put me through to the manager?*
- *Can you please speak up? I can't hear you well.*
- *When is the best time to call back?*
- *I hate salespeople who ring up like that.*
- *Could we set up a video chat later?*





Learning Points

Changing Topics on the Phone

You can use expressions to redirect a phone conversation when it is not the right time to continue or it's not someone you wish to talk to.

To let the caller know that today is not a good time for a phone conversation, you use:
Oh, this isn't really a good day.

To let the caller know that you're very busy at the moment, you use:
I'm sorry ... I'm pretty tied up right now.

To let the caller know that perhaps another time later would be better, you use:
Maybe another time.

To let the person know that there is something they might be interested in, you use:
Actually, we're running a special discount campaign right now.

To let the caller know that it isn't possible to talk right now, you use:
I really can't speak to you right now. We're terribly busy.

To apologize that you must end the conversation, you use:
I'm sorry. I must go.

To thank the caller quickly for the information and then end the phone call, you use:
Thanks so much. I've got to go.

